

Grade 4 Music Reviewer

Printable Summary · Lesson 4: Form and Texture & Lesson 5: Filipino Composers

LESSON 4: FORM AND TEXTURE

What is Texture?

Texture is an element of music that refers to the thickness and thinness of musical sound. It helps enhance the beauty of a musical piece — just like how a sandwich tastes better with more layers.

The 3 Kinds of Texture

1. Monophony

- The thinnest of the three textures — only one musical part in a song.
- The prefix “mono” means one.
- No background singers or instruments.
- Can also mean a single melody on an instrument with no accompanying harmony or chords.

2. Homophony

- Made of a single melodic line, but accompanied by chords.

3. Polyphony

- Composed of two or more melodies sounded simultaneously.
- Music with many voice parts, each with its own form and rhythm.
- The thickest texture because of the many melodies heard.

Round Song

- A short polyphonic vocal piece in canon form.
- Has two or more parts.
- The parts have different melodies.

Texture in Visual Arts

A painting can have many textures that all work together to make it beautiful, just like music has different textures and forms that make songs interesting. Even if parts are different, they can work together — showing **community and solidarity**, since everyone helps each other.

Quick Reference Table

Texture	Musical Parts	Key Idea
Monophony	One	Thinnest; no accompaniment
Homophony	One melody + chords	Melody with chordal support
Polyphony	Two or more melodies	Thickest; melodies played together

LESSON 5: FILIPINO COMPOSERS

Julian Felipe (1861–1944)

- Composer of the music of the Philippine national anthem, formerly “Marcha Nacional Filipina,” now “Lupang Hinirang.”
- A dedicated music teacher and composer.

- Appointed by President Emilio Aguinaldo as Director of the National Band of the First Philippine Republic.
- Composed nationalistic songs that inspired his compatriots to keep fighting against the Spaniards.

Nicanor Abelardo (1893–1934)

- Incorporated Philippine folk elements with Western forms and harmony.
- Known for redefining the Kundiman, bringing the genre to art song status.
- Member of the “Triumvirate of Filipino composers.”
- Composed over 140 works, including more than a hundred Kundiman songs.
- Notable works: “Nasaan ka Irog” and “Magbalik ka Hirang.”

Francisco Santiago (1889–1947)

- Known as the “Father of Kundiman.”
- Member of the “Triumvirate of Filipino composers.”
- His music was Romantic in style, blending Western forms with folk materials.
- Notable works: “Pakiusap,” “Alaala Kita,” “Ikaw at Ako,” “Pilipinas Kong Mahal.”

Antonio J. Molina (1894–1980)

- First National Artist for Music (1972).
- Known as the “Father of Philippine Impressionist Music” (the Claude Debussy of the Philippines).
- Member of the “Triumvirate of Filipino composers.”
- “Hatinggabi” is his most popular violin piece.
- Wrote hundreds of scores for chorus, orchestra, instrumental and vocal solo music, and zarzuela.

Lucio D. San Pedro (1913–2002)

- National Artist for Music (1991).
- Composer, teacher, and conductor.
- His works are strongly Romantic with nationalist themes and rich harmonies.
- Notable works: “Sa Ugoy ng Duyan” and “Simbang Gabi.”

Levi Celerio (1910–2002)

- National Artist for Music (1997).
- A creative songwriter with more than 4,000 songs, including Filipino folk, Christmas, and love songs.
- Famous for creating music with a mouth-blown leaf — a feat listed in the Guinness Book of World Records.
- Notable works: “Kalesa,” “Ang Pipit,” “Misa de Gallo.”

Ryan Cayabyab (b. 1954)

- Awarded National Artist for Music in 2018.
- One of the most popular and prolific composers in the Philippines.
- Bridged traditional music styles with contemporary, 21st-century music.
- Notable works: “Kay Ganda ng Ating Musika,” “Paraiso,” “Da Coconut Nut.”

What is a Kundiman?

- A genre of traditional Filipino love songs — a traditional serenade for loved ones, family, or country.
- Traditionally written in three-four (3/4) time, moving from minor to major tonality.
- Evolved from forms such as tango, danza, balitaw, and kumintang, now called modern kundiman.

Quick Reference Table

Composer	Known For
Julian Felipe	Composer of “Lupang Hinirang”
Nicanor Abelardo	Redefined Kundiman as art song
Francisco Santiago	“Father of Kundiman”
Antonio J. Molina	“Father of Phil. Impressionist Music”
Lucio D. San Pedro	“Sa Ugoy ng Duyan”
Levi Celerio	Music with a mouth-blown leaf
Ryan Cayabyab	National Artist for Music, 2018